

Verdant Peak Technologies - Travel Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

This Travel Policy establishes the guidelines and approval process for all business travel undertaken by Verdant Peak Technologies (VPT) employees, whether domestic or international. The policy is designed to ensure employee safety, cost efficiency, and compliance with tax and expense regulations. It applies to all employees traveling on Company business, including conferences, client visits, internal team offsites, and training programs.

2. Travel Approval Process

All business travel must be pre-approved by the employee's direct manager through the Travel & Expense Portal at least 7 working days before domestic travel and 15 working days before international travel, except in genuine emergencies. International travel additionally requires approval from the relevant Department Head if the estimated cost exceeds \$3,000, and from the Vice President if it exceeds \$8,000. Travel requests should include the business justification, destination, dates, and estimated cost; unapproved travel will not be reimbursed.

3. Booking Process

All flights, hotels, and rail travel must be booked through the Company's designated Travel Management Company (TMC), "GlobeLink Corporate Travel," accessible via the Travel Portal, to ensure duty-of-care tracking and negotiated corporate rates. Booking outside the TMC is permitted only when the TMC cannot fulfill the request (e.g., a same-day emergency booking) and requires prior written approval from the manager, with reimbursement capped at the equivalent TMC fare. Personal travel combined with business travel ("bleisure" travel) is permitted, but employees are responsible for any incremental cost and must clearly separate personal and business expenses in their claim.

4. Airfare Class of Travel

Economy class is the standard for all flights under 6 hours in duration. For flights exceeding 6 hours, employees at L6 (Director) and above are eligible for Premium Economy, and employees at L8 (Vice President) and above are eligible for Business Class. Upgrades using

personal funds or loyalty points are permitted at the employee's own discretion and cost. All employees are encouraged to book at least 14 days in advance where possible to secure the best available fares.

5. Accommodation

Hotel bookings should not exceed the Company's per-city rate caps, published and updated quarterly on the Travel Portal (e.g., a typical cap of \$250/night in major metro areas and \$150/night in secondary cities, subject to local market conditions). Employees should book standard room categories; suite upgrades are not reimbursable except when approved in advance for client-facing or safety reasons. For stays exceeding 14 consecutive nights, employees should explore extended-stay or serviced apartment options via the TMC, which are often more cost-effective than nightly hotel rates.

6. Ground Transportation

Employees should use the most cost-effective reasonable ground transportation option: public transit, ride-share (Uber/Lyft or local equivalents), or rental car. Rental cars require pre-approval and should be booked in the "mid-size" category or below unless carrying equipment or multiple colleagues requires a larger vehicle. Personal vehicle use for business travel is reimbursed at the Company's standard mileage rate, published annually by the Finance team, and requires submission of a mileage log.

7. Meals and Daily Allowance (Per Diem)

VPT provides a daily meal allowance (per diem) for business travel, varying by destination cost-of-living tier: Tier 1 cities (e.g., New York, London, Tokyo, San Francisco) at \$85/day, Tier 2 cities at \$65/day, and Tier 3 cities at \$45/day, covering breakfast, lunch, and dinner. Per diem is paid regardless of actual spend and does not require itemized receipts, though employees must confirm actual travel dates. Alcohol is not covered by per diem and must not be claimed separately unless part of an approved client entertainment event.

8. Client and Business Entertainment

Reasonable client entertainment expenses (meals, appropriate event tickets) are reimbursable with prior manager awareness and require a detailed expense claim listing attendees, company represented, and business purpose. A single client entertainment event should not exceed \$150 per person without Department Head approval. Gifts to clients are subject to the \$75 per-person annual limit outlined in the Code of Conduct's Anti-Bribery provisions.

9. International Travel Requirements

Employees traveling internationally for business must ensure their passport is valid for at least 6 months beyond the return date and are responsible for obtaining any required visas, though the Travel Portal provides visa guidance and, for complex cases, a visa concierge service. VPT provides mandatory international travel insurance, automatically applied when travel is booked through the TMC, covering medical emergencies, trip cancellation, and lost baggage.

Employees traveling to countries on the Company's Elevated Risk list (published by the Global Security team) must complete a Travel Risk Briefing before departure and check in with the Security Operations Center upon arrival and departure.

10. Expense Reporting and Reimbursement

All travel expenses must be submitted via the Travel & Expense Portal within 15 calendar days of trip completion, with original itemized receipts attached for any single expense over \$25. Expense reports are routed to the employee's manager for approval and, once approved, reimbursed via payroll within 10 working days. Expenses submitted more than 60 days after travel completion may be declined except in exceptional, documented circumstances approved by Finance.

11. Duty of Care and Emergencies

VPT partners with a global travel risk management provider that tracks all TMC-booked itineraries and can locate and assist any traveling employee in the event of a natural disaster, civil unrest, or medical emergency. Employees experiencing a travel emergency should contact the 24/7 Travel Assistance Hotline (number provided in the Travel Portal confirmation email) and notify their manager as soon as safely possible.

12. Sustainability Considerations

Where a train journey of under 4 hours is a viable alternative to a short-haul flight, employees are encouraged to choose rail travel in line with VPT's Sustainability Commitments. Video conferencing should be considered as a first option for meetings that do not strictly require in-person attendance, particularly for single-day international trips.

13. Policy Compliance

Expense claims that do not comply with this policy may be rejected or reduced at Finance's discretion. Repeated non-compliance (e.g., unapproved bookings, missing receipts, or claims inconsistent with actual travel) may result in suspension of travel booking privileges and referral to HR for further action under the Employee Policies disciplinary procedure.